



COMPETENCY STANDARD

FOR

TECHNICAL SALES SPECIALIST

(IT SECTOR)

Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP)
Finance Division, Ministry of Finance

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The Competency Standards for TECHNICAL SALES SPECIALIST (IT sector) is a document for the development of curricula, teaching and learning materials, and assessment tools. It also serves as the document for providing training consistent with the requirements of the industry for individuals who pass through the set standard via assessment would be qualified and settled for a relevant job.

This document has been developed to use in training under the **Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP)** to meet the skills requirements of the IT sector. This document is owned by the Finance Division of the Ministry of Finance of the People's Republic of Bangladesh.

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INTRODUCTION:

The Skills for Industry Competitiveness and Innovation Program (SICIP) has the overall objective of developing a skilled workforce adept at handling new technologies, especially for emerging industries in Bangladesh. It will expand skills training and strengthen the development of the training ecosystem to address the skills requirements of the SICIP-selected industry sectors. The program aims to (i) increase the technology-oriented skilled workforce across emerging and priority sectors, (ii) promote inclusive skilling and upskilling opportunities for women and socially disadvantaged groups, (iii) incentivize industry-university partnerships to nurture innovation capacity and improve industry competitiveness, and (iv) foster skills for climate-resilient manufacturing processes and green technologies. The program is expected to benefit about 220,000 new and existing workers over a 6-year implementation period from 2024-2029.

The SICIP Program has, therefore, taken the initiative to enhance the employability and productivity of trainees by implementing market-responsive and job-focused training programs through public and private training providers. This will require the development of competency standards for each of the occupations/trades which will provide a structured framework in the learning process to guide training providers, ensure consistent training quality, and create an alignment between the skills provided by the training institutes and the needs of the industry.

This competency standard is therefore developed to improve skills following the job roles and skill sets of the occupation and ensure that the required skills are aligned with industry requirements.

The document details the format, sequencing, wording, and layout of the Competency Standard for an occupation which comprises Units of Competence and its corresponding Elements.

OVERVIEW:

A **Competency Standard** is a written specification of the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required for the performance of a job or occupation or trade corresponding to the standard of performance required in the workplace.

Competency standard:

- provides a consistent and reliable set of components for training, recognizing, and assessing people's skills, and may also have optional support materials.
- enables industry-recognized qualifications to be awarded through direct assessment of workplace competencies
- encourages the development and delivery of flexible training that suits individual and industry requirements
- encourages learning and assessment in a work-related environment which leads to verifiable workplace outcomes.

Competency Standards has been developed by a working group comprised of occupation-specific experts from the industry/institution, relevant consultants of SICIP.

Competency Standards describe the skills, knowledge, and attitude needed to perform effectively in the workplace. Competency Standards acknowledge that people can achieve vocational and technical competency in many ways by emphasizing what the learner can do, not how or where they learned to do it.

With Competency Standards, assessment and training may be conducted at the workplace, at training organization, during regular work, or through work experience, work placement, work simulation or any combination of these.

A Unit of Competency describes a distinct work activity that would normally be undertaken by one person in accordance with industry standards.

Units of Competency are documented in a standard format that comprises:

- Reference to Industry Sector, Occupational Title and Occupational Description
- Unit code
- Unit title
- Unit descriptor
- Unit of Competency
- Elements and performance criteria
- Variables and range statement
- Evidence guides

Together all the parts of a Unit of Competency:

- Describe a work activity
- Guide the assessor in determining whether the candidate is competent.

Identification and validation of units of competency and elements for each occupation were made by experts from Shipbuilding industry in consultative workshop.

The ensuing sections of this document comprise a description of the respective occupation with all the key components of a Unit of Competence:

- An overview of all Units of Competence for the occupation and their corresponding duration required for completion of training.
- The Competency Standards that include the Unit of Competency, Unit Descriptor, Elements and Performance Criteria, Range of Variables, Curricular Content Guide, and Assessment Evidence Guide.

Units & Elements at a Glance:**Generic Competencies (36 hrs.)**

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-IT-TSS-01-G	Work in a team environment	1 Identify team goals and processes 2 Communicate and cooperate with team members 3 Work as a team member 4 Solve problems as a team member	12
SICIP-IT-TSS-02-G	Demonstrate Interpersonal and Communication Skills	1 Apply interpersonal skills at the workplace 2 Understand and communicate information and ideas 3 Prepare and present reports and workplace documents	12
SICIP-IT-TSS-03-G	Support Innovation and Manage Change	1 Identify needs for innovation in the workplace 2 Apply creative approach and solution 3 Support flexible and innovative ways of working 4 Adapt to emerging technological changes and opportunities	12
Total Hour			36

Sector Specific Competencies (24 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (Hours)
SICIP-IT-TSS-01-S	Access Information Using Internet and Electronic Mail	1. Access resources from internet 2. Use and manage electronic mail 3. Use audio/video tools for information transfer	12
SICIP-IT-TSS-02-S	Comply to Ethical Standards in IT Workplace	1. Uphold the requirements of clients 2. Deliver quality products and services 3. Maintain professionalism at workplace 4. Maintain workplace code of conduct	12
Total Hour			24

Occupation Specific Competencies (300 hrs.)

Code	Unit of Competency	Elements of Competency	Duration (hours)
SICIP-IT-TSS-01-O	Understand the fundamentals of technical sales	1. Analyze the principles of technical sales 2. Identify key qualities of sales professionals 3. Understand customer needs and requirements	60
SICIP-IT-TSS-02-O	Demonstrate product knowledge and technical expertise	1. Understand product features, specifications, and applications 2. Analyze competitive products and market positioning 3. Communicate technical product information effectively 4. Stay updated on product developments and industry advancements	40
SICIP-IT-TSS-03-O	Perform business development activities	1. Design a business profile 2. Develop a business proposal 3. Examine customer relationship management (CRM)	80
SICIP-IT-TSS-04-O	Perform sales	1. Carry out promotional activities 2. Present IT products and solutions 3. Negotiate terms and close sales deals 4. Handle customer queries and observations 5. Follow up and ensure customer satisfaction	120
Total Hours			00

COMPETENCY STANDARD: TECHNICAL SALES SPECIALIST

Generic Competencies

Unit of Competency: WORK IN A TEAM ENVIRONMENT	Nominal Duration: 12 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-01-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in a team environment. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying team goals and processes, communicating and cooperating with team members, working as a team member and solving problems as a team member.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify team goals and processes	1.1 Team goals and collaborative decision-making processes are identified. 1.2 Role and common goals of the team are defined from available <u>sources of information</u> . 1.3 Team structure, responsibilities and reporting relations are identified from team discussions and other external sources.
2. Communicate and cooperate with team members	1.4 Communication and negotiation skills are applied and maintained in all relevant situations. 1.5 Constructive contributions are made to <u>workplace discussions</u> on such issues as production, quality and safety. 1.6 Goals/ objectives and action plans undertaken in the workplace are communicated promptly. 1.7 Information regarding problems and issues are organized coherently to ensure clear and effective communication. 1.8 Dialogue is initiated with appropriate personnel. 1.9 Communication problems and issues are raised 1.10 Barriers to communication are identified and resolved
3. Work as a team member	1.1 Effective forms of communication are used to interact with <u>team members</u> in discussing team activities and objectives. 1.2 Mutual respect, empathy and active collaboration are demonstrated 1.3 Communication channels are followed as per <u>workplace context</u> .
4. Solve problems as a	1.1 Current and potential problems faced by team are

team member	identified. 1.2 Problems are investigated and analysed. 1.3 Potential solutions of problem are identified. 1.4 Recommendations about possible solutions are developed, documented, ranked and presented to team members for decision.
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Range of variables:

Variables	Range (may include but not limited to)
1. Sources of information	1.1 Organizational structures 1.2 Operations Manuals 1.3 Job description 1.4 Standard operating procedures
2. Workplace discussions	1.1 Coordination meetings 1.2 Toolbox discussion 1.3 Peer-to-peer discussion
3. Team members	1.1 Coach / members 1.2 Supervisor / manager 1.3 Peers / colleagues 1.4 Other members /Employee representative of the organization.
4. Workplace context	1.1 National Laws and Statutes 1.2 Standard Operating Procedures 1.3 Workplace Rules and Regulations

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning knowledge	1.1 Sources of information define 1.2 Team structure, role, and responsibility. 1.3 Individual member's roles and responsibilities. 1.4 Effective verbal communication methods 1.5 Communication flow and reporting structures. 1.6 Interpersonal communication skills. 1.7 Organization requirements for written and electronic communication methods 1.8 Communication problems and issues 1.9 Barriers in communication 1.10 Team planning. 1.11 Team meeting procedures. 1.12 Workplace etiquette 1.13 Industry maintenance, service and helpdesk practices, processes and procedures 1.14 Industry standard diagnostic tools 1.15 Malfunctions and resolutions
2. Underpinning skill	1.16 Organizing sources of information 1.17 Identifying the role and responsibility of the team. 1.18 Identifying roles and responsibilities of individual

	members. 1.19 Identifying effective verbal communication methods 1.20 Identifying communication flow and reporting structure. 1.21 Identifying interpersonal communication skills 1.22 Complying with organization requirements for the use of written and electronic communication methods 1.23 Communicating skills 1.24 Participating in team discussion. 1.25 Working as a team member. 1.26 Participating in a variety of workplace discussions 1.27 Effective clarifying and probing skills 1.28 Identifying issues 1.29 Identifying current industry standard diagnostic tools 1.30 Describing common malfunctions and resolutions. 1.31 Determining the root cause of a routine malfunction
3. Underpinning Attitudes	1.32 Commitment to occupational health and safety 1.33 Promptness in carrying out activities 1.34 Sincere and honest to duties 1.35 Environmental concerns 1.36 Eagerness to learn 1.37 Tidiness and timeliness 1.38 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 1.39 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource implications	The following resources must be provided: 1.40 Workplace (actual or simulated). 1.41 Relevant materials and equipment. 1.42 Relevant specifications or work instructions.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical aspects of competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified team goals and processes 1.2 communicated and cooperated with team members 1.3 worked as a team member 1.4 solved problems as a team member
2. Methods of assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical Demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified

	assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.
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Unit of Competency: DEMONSTRATE INTERPERSONAL AND COMMUNICATION SKILLS	Nominal Duration: 12 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-02-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to demonstrate interpersonal and communication skills. It specifically includes the tasks of applying interpersonal skills at the workplace, understanding and communicating information and ideas, preparing and presenting reports and workplace documents.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Apply interpersonal skills at the workplace	1.1 <u>Workplace interpersonal skills</u> are interpreted. 1.2 The impacts of interpersonal skills are described. 1.3 Interpersonal skills are performed in accordance with workplace procedures. 1.4 <u>Ways of improving interpersonal skills</u> are identified and followed.
2. Understand and communicate information and ideas	2.1 <u>Communication tools and equipment</u> are operated, and faults are identified and reported. 2.2 Consultative processes are used to collect and convey information. 2.3 Information systems is used to store, retrieve and update information. 2.4 Information data and information are analyzed and interpreted. 2.5 Information is communicated with individuals and groups.
3. Prepare and present reports and workplace documents	3.1 <u>Workplace documents</u> are interpreted. 3.2 Appropriate format for document is used to meet workplace requirements. 3.3 Document is drafted in accordance with workplace procedures. 3.4 Document is edited and presented in a final version appropriate to task.

Range of variables:

Variables	Range (may include but not limited to)
1. Workplace Interpersonal skills	1.1 Effective communication 1.2 Cooperation 1.3 Giving and receiving feedback, feed-forward and professional criticism 1.4 Pressure handling

	1.5 Time management 1.6 Acceptance of diversity 1.7 Supporting and encouraging others 1.8 Inclusiveness 1.9 Problem solving 1.10 Negotiation 1.11 Conflict management
2. Ways of improving interpersonal skills	1.1 Cultivate a positive outlook 1.2 Ask trusted friends or colleagues for constructive criticism 1.3 Control emotions 1.4 Observe other positive interpersonal interactions 1.5 Practice active listening 1.6 Seek out opportunities to build relationships 1.4 Practice empathy
3. Communication tools and equipment	1.1 Telephone 1.2 Internet 1.3 Mobile Phone 1.4 Fax machines 1.4 Two-way radio
4. Workplace documents	1.1 Business Letters 1.2 Business Reports 1.3 Transactional Documents 1.4 Memos 1.5 Forms 1.5.1 Memorandum 1.5.2 Requisitioning Form 1.5.3 Personnel Form 1.6 Safety Report Form

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning knowledge	1.1 Interpersonal skills 1.2 Impacts of interpersonal skills 1.3 Consultative processes 1.4 Workplace documents
2. Underpinning skill	1.5 Demonstrating interpersonal skills 1.6 Collecting workplace information 1.7 Analyzing information and ideas 1.8 Preparing workplace documents 1.9 Presenting workplace documents
3. Underpinning Attitudes	1.10 Commitment to occupational health and safety 1.11 Promptness in carrying out activities 1.12 Sincere and honest to duties 1.13 Environmental concerns 1.14 Eagerness to learn 1.15 Tidiness and timeliness 1.16 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace

	1.17 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource implications	The following resources must be provided: 1.1 Workplace (actual or simulated). 1.2 Relevant materials and equipment. 1.3 Relevant specifications or work instructions.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical aspects of competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 applied interpersonal skills at the workplace 1.2 understood and communicated information and ideas 1.3 prepared and presented reports and workplace documents
2. Methods of assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 1.4 Written test 1.5 Practical Demonstration 1.6 Oral questioning 1.7 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of assessment	1.8 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 1.9 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: SUPPORT INNOVATION AND MANAGE CHANGE	Nominal Duration: 12 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-03-G
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills, and attitudes required to support innovation and manage change. It specifically includes the tasks of identifying needs for innovation in the workplace, applying creative approaches and solution, supporting flexible and innovative ways of working and adapting to emerging technological changes and opportunities.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Identify needs for innovation in the workplace	1.1. The need for <u>innovation</u> in scope of work is recognized 1.2. The value of <u>innovative practices</u> in the workplace is recognized 1.3. Existing way of working in the workplace are interpreted. 1.4. Drawbacks of existing way of working are identified. 1.5. Benefits of change are identified to make it consistent with organizational requirements 1.6. Realistic timelines and targets for implementation of changes are set.
2. Apply creative approach and solution	2.1. Opportunities and creative approaches to implement innovation practices are identified 2.2. Creative approaches of coworkers pertaining to work practices are analyzed and incorporated 2.3. Innovation in accordance with organizational requirements changes are implemented
3. Support flexible and innovative ways of working	3.1. Maximum innovative opportunities are promoted. 3.2. Work assignments to facilitate innovative work skills are organized. 3.3. Team members are provided with guidance and coaching on innovation in the workplace. 3.4. Models of innovative work practice are provided and discussed 3.5. Appropriate environment for learning and innovation is maintained.
4. Adapt to emerging technological changes and opportunities	4.1. Usages of different <u>technologies</u> is determined based on job requirements. 4.2. Appropriate technology is selected as per work specifications. 4.3. Relevant technology is effectively used in carrying out functions.

	4.4. Appropriate implementation tools are used as per task requirement.
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Range of variables:

Variables	Range (may include but not limited to)
1. Innovation	1.1. New ideas 1.2. Different ideas 1.3. New methods of doing work 1.4. Use of new Technology
2. Innovative practices	2.1 Self-directed support to implement new ideas 2.2 Collaborative arrangement to apply new method of working 2.3 Making scope of work more efficient to use new technology
3. Technologies	3.1 Office technology 3.2 Industrial technology 3.3 System technology 3.4 Information technology 3.5 Training technology

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning knowledge	1.1. Definition of innovation 1.2. Current practice in own scope of work 1.3. Workplace procedures 1.4. Support required to generate creative ideas 1.5. Difference between innovation and creativity 1.6. Common effects of change and innovation in the workplace 1.7. Industrial and organizational context of change 1.8. Organization's policies, plans, procedures and structure 1.9. Knowledge of resources required by the organization's operations 1.10. Awareness on technology and its function 1.11. Operating instructions 1.12. Applicable software 1.13. Company policy in relation to relevant technology 1.14. Technology adaptability
2. Underpinning skill	1.1. Identifying resources required for creativity and innovation 1.2. Contributing to brainstorming session 1.3. Identifying issues and concerns of one's scope of work 1.4. Encouraging co-workers to generate and develop ideas 1.5. Evaluating potential obstacles to and opportunities for creativity and innovation 1.6. Sharing of best practices related to innovation and creativity 1.7. Applying relevant technology 1.8. Using update machine and Software

	1.9. Acquiring troubleshooting skills Identifying issues 1.10. Identifying current industry standard diagnostic tools 1.11. Describing common malfunctions and resolutions. 1.12. Determining the root cause of a routine malfunction
3. Underpinning Attitudes	1.13. Commitment to occupational health and safety 1.14. Promptness in carrying out activities 1.15. Sincere and honest to duties 1.16. Environmental concerns 1.17. Eagerness to learn 1.18. Tidiness and timeliness 1.19. Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 1.20. Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource implications	The following resources must be provided: 1.21. Workplace (actual or simulated). 1.22. Relevant materials and equipment. 1.23. Relevant specifications or work instructions.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical aspects of competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 identified need for innovation in the workplace 1.2 applied creative approach and solution 1.3 supported flexible and innovative ways of working 1.4 adapted to emerging technological changes and opportunities
2. Methods of assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

The Sector Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: ACCESS INFORMATION USING INTERNET AND ELECTRONIC MAIL	Nominal Duration: 12 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-01-S
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to access information using internet and electronic mail. It specifically includes the tasks of accessing resources from internet, using and managing electronic mail, and using audio/video tools for information transfer.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Access resources from internet	1.1 Appropriate internet <u>browsers</u> are selected and installed. 1.2 Internet browser is opened and web address / URL is written/selected in /from address bar to access <u>information.</u> 1.3 <u>Search engines</u> are used to access information 1.4 Video / Information are Shared /downloaded / uploaded from / to web site/ <u>social media.</u> 1.5 <u>Web based resources</u> are used. 1.6 Etiquette (or web etiquette) principles are searched and followed.
2. Use and manage electronic mail	2.1 <u>Email services</u> are identified and selected to create a new email address 2.2 Mail account is created. 2.3 Document is prepared, attached and sent to different types of recipient. 2.4 Mail is read, forwarded, replied and deleted as per requirement. 2.5 Custom email folders are created and manipulated. 2.6 Mail message is printed.
2. Use audio/video tools for information transfer	2.1 Audio and video tools are identified 2.2 Apps using audio/video tools are identified 2.3 Information is transferred with apps using audio/video tools

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. Browsers	1.1 Mozilla Firefox 1.2 Google chrome 1.3 Internet explorer 1.4 Opera

2. Information	2.1. Text information 2.2. Graphics 2.3. Video
3. Search engines	3.1. Google 3.2. Yahoo 3.3. AltaVista 3.4. Msn 3.5. Bing
4. Social media.	4.1 Face book 4.2 Twitter 4.3 LinkedIn 4.4 YouTube
5. Web based resources	5.1 Drive 5.2 Calendar 5.3 Map 5.4 Translator 5.5 Docs 5.6 Search
6. Email services	6.1 Free mail services –Gmail, Yahoo, Hotmail 6.2 Web mail services.

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Internet 1.2 www 1.3 web site 1.4 web address 1.5 URL 1.6 Web browsers 1.7 Search engines 1.8 Information 1.9 Social media 1.10 Web based services 1.11 Folder manipulation
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Accessing and sharing resources from internet 2.2 Downloading /uploading file, documents and video from /to web sites 2.3 Sending and receiving mail through mail service. 2.4 Using audio/video tools to share information
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors

	in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	4.1 Relevant tools, Equipment, software and facilities needed to perform the activities. 4.2 Required learning materials.

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 accessed resources from internet 1.2 used and managed electronic mail 1.3 used audio/video tools for information transfer
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical Demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Workplace (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: COMPLY TO ETHICAL STANDARDS IN IT WORKPLACE	Nominal Duration: 12 hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-02-S
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to comply to ethical standards in IT workplace. It specifically includes the tasks of upholding the requirements of clients, delivering quality products and services, maintaining professionalism at workplace and maintaining workplace code of conduct.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Uphold the requirements of clients	1.1 Clients' requirements are identified. 1.2 Confidentiality of information is maintained in accordance with workplace policies/organizational policies/ <u>national legislation</u> . 1.3 Potential conflicts of interest are identified and involved parties of potential conflicts are notified. 1.4 Proprietary rights of client/customer are asserted.
2. Deliver quality products and services	2.1 Products and services are provided according to the clients' requirements. 2.2 Work is completed as per standards. 2.3 Quality processes are implemented when developing products and services.
3. Maintain professionalism at workplace	3.1 Work processes are delivered as per standards. 3.2 Skills, knowledge and qualifications are presented in a professional manner. 3.3 Services and products developed by self and others are delivered as per workplace standard. 3.4 Unbiased and objective information are provided to clients. 3.5 Realistic estimates for time, cost and delivery of outputs are presented during negotiation.
4. Maintain workplace code of conduct.	4.1 Workplace code of conduct are interpreted 4.2 Workplace code of conduct is followed.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range
	May include but not limited to:
1. National legislation	1.1 Industry/sector code of ethics 1.2 International and national guidelines for customer protection 1.3 International and national copyright laws 1.4 Occupational health and safety requirements

	1.5 Intellectual property rights law
	1.6 Legal and regulatory policies in the information technology sector
	1.7 Fire safety rules and regulations

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Corporate code of confidentiality of information organizational policies, national legislation and workplace policies in relation to IT sector 1.2 Law and regulations pertaining to proprietary rights 1.3 Quality processes for products and services 1.4 Procedure of provided to client information 1.5 Method of estimating for time, cost and delivery products and services 1.6 Workplace code of conduct in IT sector
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Upholding confidentiality of information in accordance with organizational policies, national legislation and workplace policies 2.2 Asserting proprietary rights of client/customer 2.3 Completing work in accordance with industry and international standards 2.4 Implementing quality processes when developing products and services 2.5 Delivering correctly services and products developed by self and others 2.6 Providing unbiased and objective information are to clients. 2.7 Presenting realistic estimates for time, cost and delivery of outputs during negotiation 2.8 Following workplace code of conduct
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4. Resource Implications	4.1 Workplace (simulated or actual) 4.2 Work books 4.3 Operation and maintenance manuals

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate:
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	1.1 upheld the requirements of clients. 1.2 delivered quality products and services 1.3 maintained professionalism at workplace 1.4 maintained workplace code of conduct
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical Demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

The Occupation Specific Competencies

Unit of Competency: UNDERSTAND THE FUNDAMENTALS OF TECHNICAL SALES	Nominal Duration: 60 Hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-1-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to understand the fundamentals of technical sales. It specifically includes the tasks of analyzing the principles of technical sales, identifying key qualities of sales professionals and understanding customer needs and requirements.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Analyze the principles of technical sales	1.1 <u>Technical knowledge in sales</u> and its importance are recognized. 1.2 Principles of technical sales are explained following best practices. 1.3 Differences between <u>conventional/traditional sales</u> and technical sales are comprehended. 1.4 Core principles of technical sales are understood based on market trends and customer needs.
2. Identify key qualities of sales professionals	2.1 <u>Essential traits of sales professionals</u> are recognized. 2.2 The roles of adaptability and resilience in handling sales challenges are identified. 2.3 <u>Customer-centric approaches</u> are demonstrated in sales activities.
3. Understand customer needs and requirements	3.1 <u>Effective questioning techniques</u> to gather information are used. 3.2 Key <u>factors influencing customer purchasing</u> decisions are identified. 3.3 Customer information and experiences are analyzed to determine technical sales solutions. 3.4 Customer requirements are summarized and documented.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range (Includes but not limited to):
1. Technical knowledge in Sales	1.1 IT solutions 1.2 Industrial machinery 1.3 Medical devices
2. Conventional/traditional Sales	2.1 Retail 2.2 FMCG
3. Essential traits of sales	3.1 Communication skills

professionals	3.2 Problem-solving 3.3 Adaptability 3.4 Resilience 3.5 Customer orientation
4. Customer-Centric Approaches	4.1 Active listening 4.2 Relationship-building 4.3 Personalized solutions
5. Effective Questioning Techniques	5.1 Open-ended questions 5.2 Probing questions 5.3 Needs analysis
6. Factors Influencing customer purchasing	6.1 Price 6.2 Quality 6.3 Brand reputation 6.4 After-sales service 6.5 Customer needs

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Fundamentals and significance of technical sales 1.2 Key principles of technical sales 1.3 Differences between technical and traditional sales 1.4 Essential skills and qualities of sales professionals 1.5 Customer psychology and decision-making processes 1.6 Techniques for understanding customer needs
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Analyzing and explaining technical sales concepts 2.2 Differentiating technical sales from traditional sales 2.3 Identifying and demonstrating key sales professional qualities 2.4 Conducting effective customer needs analysis 2.5 Summarizing and documenting customer requirements
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4 Resource Implications	4.1 Training facility or workplace (simulated or actual). 4.2 Learning materials on technical sales principles. 4.3 Case studies and role-playing exercises. 4.4 Assessment tools (written, practical, and oral evaluations).

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 analyzed the principles of technical sales 1.2 identified key qualities of sales professionals 1.3 understood customer needs and requirements
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: DEMONSTRATE PRODUCT KNOWLEDGE AND TECHNICAL EXPERTISE	Nominal Duration: 40 Hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-2-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to demonstrate product knowledge and technical expertise. It specifically includes the tasks of understanding product features, specifications and applications, analyzing competitive products and market positioning, communicating technical product information effectively and staying updated on product developments and industry advancements.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Understand product features, specifications, and applications	1.1 <u>Product features and specifications</u> are identified. 1.2 Product functionality and <u>product applications</u> are explained. 1.3 Product variations, performance, and suitability to customer needs are compared and explained.
2. Analyze competitive products and market positioning	2.1 <u>Comparative analysis</u> of competitor products and their marketing strategies is conducted. 2.2 <u>Sales positioning</u> mapping based on competitors' sales strategies is carried out.
3. Communicate technical product information effectively	3.1 Complex <u>technical communication</u> for different customer segments is simplified. 3.2 Customer priorities are recognized to present the product effectively. 3.3 Demonstrations, diagrams, or case studies are used to explain product benefits. 3.4 Technical queries are addressed to ensure customer understanding.
4. Stay updated on product developments and industry advancements	4.1 <u>Emerging trends</u> are researched and analyzed to update and customize product information. 4.2 Training sessions, workshops, and industry events are organized to ensure <u>Continuing Professional Development (CPD)</u> . 4.3 Updated knowledge is applied to enhance sales and customer service interactions.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range (Includes but not limited to):
1. Product Features and Specifications	1.1 Dimensions 1.2 Material 1.3 Performance 1.4 Durability 1.5 Functionality

2. Product Applications	2.1 Use cases in different industries 2.2 Compatibility 2.3 Customer requirements
3. Comparative analysis	3.1 Product comparison 3.2 Pricing 3.3 Marketing strategies 3.4 Brand positioning
4. Sales Positioning	4.1 Unique selling points 4.2 Customer benefits 4.3 Competitor differentiation
5. Technical Communication	5.1 Verbal presentations 5.2 Product demonstrations 5.3 Documentation, visuals
6. Emerging trends	6.1 Innovations 6.2 Regulatory changes 6.3 Customer preferences 6.4 Emerging technologies
7. Continuing Professional Development (CPD)	7.1 Workshops 7.2 Certifications 7.3 Industry conferences 7.4 Online courses

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Fundamentals of product specifications and applications 1.2 Methods for analyzing competitive products and sales positioning 1.3 Strategies for effectively communicating technical information 1.4 Techniques for simplifying complex product details for customers 1.5 Importance of staying updated on industry advancements
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Identifying and explaining product features, specifications, and applications 2.2 Conducting competitive analysis and mapping sales positioning 2.3 Presenting technical information clearly using demonstrations, diagrams, or case studies 2.4 Addressing customer technical queries confidently 2.5 Researching and applying industry advancements to sales strategies
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn

	3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4 Resource Implications	4.1 Training facility or workplace (simulated or actual). 4.2 Learning materials on technical sales principles. 4.3 Case studies and role-playing exercises. 4.4 Assessment tools (written, practical, and oral evaluations).

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 understood product features, specifications, and applications 1.2 analyzed competitive products and market positioning 1.3 communicated technical product information effectively 1.4 stayed updated on product developments and industry advancements
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES	Nominal Duration: 80 Hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-03-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to perform business development activities. It specifically includes the tasks of designing a business profile, developing a business proposal and examining customer relationship management (CRM).		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Design a business profile	1.1 Purpose of a <u>business profile</u> is accurately explained. 1.2 Key characteristics of a business profile are identified and explained. 1.3 Business profile is designed based on key characteristics and industry requirements.
2. Develop a business proposal	2.1 Purpose of a business proposal is accurately explained. 2.2 <u>Key components of a business proposal</u> are identified. 2.3 Business proposal is developed and aligned with key components.
3. Examine customer relationship management (CRM)	3.1 <u>Goal of customer relationship management (CRM)</u> is defined. 3.2 <u>CRM skills</u> for building effective customer relationships are identified and described. 3.3 <u>Customer expectations</u> are critically examined and interpreted.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range (Includes but not limited to):
1. Business Profile	1.1 Company overview 1.2 Mission 1.3 Vision 1.4 Values 1.5 Products/services 1.6 Market positioning
2. Key components of a business proposal	2.1 Executive summary 2.2 Problem statement 2.3 Solution 2.4 Benefits 2.5 Cost structure 2.6 Timeline
3. Goal of customer relationship management (CRM)	3.1 Customer retention 3.2 Relationship building

	3.3 Customer satisfaction 3.4 Loyalty
4. CRM Skills	4.1 Active listening 4.2 Effective communication 4.3 Problem-solving 4.4 Empathy
5. Customer Expectations	5.1 Product quality 5.2 Service excellence 5.3 Support responsiveness 5.4 Personalized engagement

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Importance and structure of a business profile 1.2 Key elements of a business proposal and their relevance 1.3 Fundamentals of customer relationship management (CRM) 1.4 Strategies for building and maintaining customer relationships 1.5 Methods for identifying and analyzing customer expectations
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Designing a business profile that aligns with business goals 2.2 Developing a structured and persuasive business proposal 2.3 Identifying and applying CRM techniques to improve customer engagement 2.4 Evaluating customer expectations and aligning business strategies accordingly
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4 Resource Implications	4.1 Training facility or workplace (simulated or actual). 4.2 Learning materials on technical sales principles. 4.3 Case studies and role-playing exercises. 4.4 Assessment tools (written, practical, and oral evaluations).

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 designed a business profile
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	1.2 developed a business proposal 1.3 examined customer relationship management (CRM)
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical Demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

Unit of Competency: PERFORM SALES	Nominal Duration: 120 Hrs.	Unit Code: SICIP-IT-TSS-04-O
Unit Descriptor: This unit covers the knowledge, skills and attitude required to perform sales. It specifically includes the tasks of carrying out promotional activities, presenting IT products and solutions, negotiating terms and close sales deals, handling customer queries and observations and following up and ensuring customer satisfaction.		

Elements and Performance Criteria:

(Terms in the performance criteria that are written in **bold and underlined** are elaborated in the range of variables).

Elements of Competency	Performance Criteria
1. Carry out promotional activities	1.1 <u>Marketing materials</u> such as brochures, digital content, and product videos are designed and created. 1.2 <u>Promotional campaigns</u> highlighting IT products and services are demonstrated. 1.3 <u>Online platforms</u> are used effectively to promote product sales.
2. Present IT products and solutions	2.1 Tailored <u>sales presentations</u> indicating products and services are prepared. 2.2 Technical specifications, benefits and features of products are explained. 2.3 Live presentations, case studies and success stories are used to enhance credibility. 2.4 Product solution services along with after-sales service commitments are explained.
3. Negotiate terms and close sales deals	3.1 Pricing, discounts, and service agreements based on customer needs are discussed. 3.2 Persuasive communication and <u>negotiation techniques</u> are applied. 3.3 Sales contracts ensuring both parties agree on terms and conditions are finalized. 3.4 Order details, delivery timelines and <u>after-sales support services</u> are explained and confirmed.
4. Handle customer queries and observations	4.1 Customer concerns are addressed with explanation and factual information. 4.2 Solutions or incentives to mitigate customer queries or objections are provided. 4.3 Queries, observations and feedback are documented and communicated to the production unit for improvement.
5. Follow up and ensure customer satisfaction	5.1 Follow-up calls and meetings to ensure <u>customer satisfaction</u> are conducted. 5.2 Customers with post-sales inquiries or technical support needs are assisted. 5.3 <u>Feedback</u> for continuous improvement of sales and

	service processes is gathered.
	5.4 Long-term relationships with customers for future business opportunities are maintained.

Range of Variables

Variable	Range (Includes but not limited to):
1. Marketing Materials	1.1 Brochures 1.2 Digital ads 1.3 Product videos 1.4 Social media content 1.5 Email campaigns
2. Promotional Campaigns	2.1 Product launches 2.2 Webinars 2.3 Trade shows 2.4 Online marketing
3. Online Platforms	3.1 Social media 3.2 E-commerce websites 3.3 Digital advertising 3.4 Email marketing
4. Sales Presentations	4.1 Face-to-face 4.2 Virtual meetings 4.3 Product demonstrations 4.4 Interactive presentations
5. Negotiation Techniques	5.1 Persuasive communication 5.2 Active listening 5.3 Handling objections 5.4 Value-based pricing
6. After-Sales Services	6.1 Product training 6.2 Technical support 6.3 Warranty 6.4 Maintenance 6.5 Upgrades
7. Customer Satisfaction Methods	7.1 Follow-up calls 7.2 Surveys 7.3 Meetings 7.4 Customer support services
8. Feedback	8.1 Customer reviews 8.2 Service evaluation forms 8.3 Direct interactions 8.4 Online feedback

Curricular Content Guide

1. Underpinning Knowledge	1.1 Principles of sales promotion and marketing strategies 1.2 Effective sales presentation techniques for IT products 1.3 Methods of negotiating and closing sales deals 1.4 Strategies for handling customer objections and concerns
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	1.5 Importance of after-sales services and customer satisfaction 1.6 Techniques for maintaining long-term customer relationships
2. Underpinning Skills	2.1 Designing and executing promotional campaigns 2.2 Delivering persuasive and tailored sales presentations 2.3 Applying negotiation techniques to finalize sales deals 2.4 Resolving customer concerns and objections professionally 2.5 Conducting follow-ups to ensure customer satisfaction 2.6 Building and maintaining strong business relationships
3. Underpinning Attitudes	3.1 Commitment to occupational health and safety 3.2 Promptness in carrying out activities 3.3 Sincere and honest to duties 3.4 Environmental concerns 3.5 Eagerness to learn 3.6 Tidiness and timeliness 3.7 Respect for rights of peers and seniors in the workplace 3.8 Communication with peers, subordinates and seniors in the workplace
4 Resource Implications	4.1 Training facility or workplace (simulated or actual). 4.2 Learning materials on technical sales principles. 4.3 Case studies and role-playing exercises. 4.4 Assessment tools (written, practical, and oral evaluations).

Assessment Evidence Guide

1. Critical Aspects of Competency	Assessment required evidence that the candidate: 1.1 carried out promotional activities 1.2 presented IT products and solutions 1.3 negotiated terms and close sales deals 1.4 handled customer queries and observations 1.5 followed up and ensured customer satisfaction
2. Methods of Assessment	Competency should be assessed by: 2.1 Written test 2.2 Practical demonstration 2.3 Oral questioning 2.4 Portfolio (Optional)
3. Context of Assessment	3.1 Competency assessment must be done in an assessment/training center or in an actual or simulated work place after completion of the training. 3.2 Assessment should be done by a nationally certified assessor or occupation-specific industry expert.

End of the Competency Standard

Workshop/Lab Facility Standard

Course Name:	Technical Sales Specialist (IT Sector)
Number of Trainees:	25

Course-wise Training Space (Theoretical Classroom, Workshop/ Lab/ Classroom cum Workshop):

- Classroom – 350 sft (33 sqm)
- Workshop/ lab – 800 sft (75 sqm)
OR
- Classroom cum workshop – 1000 sft (93 sqm)

Major Training Equipment and Training Facilities:

Sl. No.	Major Equipment and Training facilities	Required facilities
1.	Computer/Laptops with internet facility	26
2.	Multimedia projector & screen	1

The following conditions must be fulfilled –

- The institute shall not use the same facilities for any other projects/organizations offering a similar course.
- The institute must provide sufficient evidence to prove ownership of the proposed training equipment.

The list denotes the minimum training equipment and facility required to effectively conduct training for a specific course. Additionally, the institute must ensure that all other necessary training tools, equipment, and furniture are available to meet the requirement of competency standards (CS) provided by SICIP.

For the operation of training course on Technical Sales Specialist (IT Sector), the institute must ensure the availability of at least 80% of the major training equipment and training facilities (according to the CS) to be eligible for SICIP training delivery. If the score is below 80%, the remaining equipment and facilities need to be installed before the commencement of the training.

The institute will also provide all other hand tools and power tools as per CS for 25 trainees. Also, they will arrange adequate seating arrangement and classroom setup for the 25 trainees.